IT Incident Management Standard Operating Procedure

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1. Purpose

This procedure defines how technology incidents are identified, prioritized, investigated, resolved, and communicated.

The objective is to restore normal service as quickly as possible while minimizing business impact.

2. Incident Priorities

Priority 1 - Critical: severe business impact, such as a major customer-facing service unavailable, a production platform completely unavailable, a significant security breach, or critical business operations unable to continue.

Priority 2 - High: major degradation that does not completely stop critical business operations.

Priority 3 - Medium: affects a limited group of users or a non-critical service.

Priority 4 - Low: minor business impact, general service requests, or cosmetic issues.

3. Incident Logging

All incidents must be recorded in the approved IT service-management platform.

- The incident record should include a description.
- The affected service and business impact must be recorded.
- The priority, reporter details, investigation notes, and resolution information must be maintained.

4. Major Incident Process

For Priority 1 incidents, the Service Desk or monitoring team must immediately notify the Major Incident Manager.

The Major Incident Manager coordinates technical response teams, business communications, stakeholder updates, escalations, and recovery activities.

A dedicated communication channel may be created for incident coordination.

5. Incident Communication

For major incidents, stakeholders should receive regular status updates covering current impact, actions underway, known workarounds, and estimated recovery information when available.

Teams must avoid sharing unverified root-cause assumptions.

6. Resolution

Before closing an incident, the responsible team must confirm that service has been restored.

The incident record must include the final resolution. For significant incidents, monitoring should continue after recovery to verify stability.

7. Problem Management

Recurring or high-impact incidents should be considered for problem-management review.

Problem management focuses on identifying and addressing the underlying root cause rather than only restoring service.

8. Post-Incident Review

Priority 1 incidents require a post-incident review.

- The review should document the timeline and business impact.
- The review should document root cause, detection effectiveness, and response effectiveness.
- Corrective and preventive actions must have owners and target completion dates.